

Table 1: CEO Uncertainty and Cash Holdings

|                     | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                           | (8)                           | (9)                           | (10)                          | (11)                          | (12)                          |
|---------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                     | CashRatio                     |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               | CashRatio_lead                |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               |
| ClarityCEO          | <b>-0.0046*</b><br>(0.0033)   | <b>-0.0071*</b><br>(0.0051)   | <b>-0.0058**</b><br>(0.0033)  | -0.0054<br>(0.0048)           | <b>-0.0056**</b><br>(0.0033)  | -0.0052<br>(0.0047)           | -0.0016<br>(0.0040)           | <b>-0.0169**</b><br>(0.0082)  | -0.0022<br>(0.0040)           | <b>-0.0169**</b><br>(0.0080)  | -0.0025<br>(0.0040)           | <b>-0.0168**</b><br>(0.0080)  |
| UncResCEO           | <b>0.0021**</b><br>(0.0010)   | <b>0.0019**</b><br>(0.0010)   | <b>0.0020**</b><br>(0.0010)   | <b>0.0016*</b><br>(0.0010)    | <b>0.0021**</b><br>(0.0010)   | <b>0.0016*</b><br>(0.0010)    | 0.0011<br>(0.0013)            | 0.0015<br>(0.0012)            | 0.0010<br>(0.0013)            | 0.0013<br>(0.0012)            | 0.0008<br>(0.0013)            | 0.0012<br>(0.0012)            |
| UncPreCEO           | 0.0002<br>(0.0011)            | 0.0009<br>(0.0011)            | 0.0003<br>(0.0011)            | 0.0006<br>(0.0011)            | 0.0004<br>(0.0011)            | 0.0007<br>(0.0011)            | -0.0011<br>(0.0017)           | 0.0002<br>(0.0016)            | -0.0015<br>(0.0017)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0015)           | -0.0017<br>(0.0017)           | -0.0003<br>(0.0016)           |
| Leverage            | <b>-0.0177***</b><br>(0.0048) | <b>-0.0355***</b><br>(0.0084) | <b>-0.0130***</b><br>(0.0036) | <b>-0.0218***</b><br>(0.0082) | <b>-0.0132***</b><br>(0.0037) | <b>-0.0216***</b><br>(0.0082) | <b>-0.0274***</b><br>(0.0102) | <b>-0.0184*</b><br>(0.0103)   | <b>-0.0266***</b><br>(0.0101) | -0.0123<br>(0.0102)           | <b>-0.0264***</b><br>(0.0100) | -0.0118<br>(0.0101)           |
| lnAssets            | <b>-0.0015***</b><br>(0.0006) | <b>-0.0177***</b><br>(0.0026) | <b>-0.0017***</b><br>(0.0005) | <b>-0.0175***</b><br>(0.0026) | <b>-0.0014***</b><br>(0.0005) | <b>-0.0170***</b><br>(0.0026) | <b>-0.0019**</b><br>(0.0008)  | <b>-0.0208***</b><br>(0.0036) | <b>-0.0014*</b><br>(0.0008)   | <b>-0.0210***</b><br>(0.0036) | <b>-0.0015*</b><br>(0.0008)   | <b>-0.0212***</b><br>(0.0036) |
| TobinsQ             | <b>0.0058***</b><br>(0.0006)  | <b>0.0048***</b><br>(0.0009)  | <b>0.0042***</b><br>(0.0007)  | <b>0.0037***</b><br>(0.0010)  | <b>0.0040***</b><br>(0.0007)  | <b>0.0034***</b><br>(0.0010)  | <b>0.0058***</b><br>(0.0011)  | 0.0008<br>(0.0014)            | <b>0.0043***</b><br>(0.0011)  | -0.0003<br>(0.0014)           | <b>0.0044***</b><br>(0.0011)  | 0.0000<br>(0.0014)            |
| ROA                 | -0.0144<br>(0.0093)           | <b>0.0214**</b><br>(0.0105)   | <b>-0.0679***</b><br>(0.0113) | -0.0195<br>(0.0122)           | <b>-0.0630***</b><br>(0.0114) | -0.0171<br>(0.0122)           | <b>-0.0775***</b><br>(0.0130) | <b>-0.0438***</b><br>(0.0168) | <b>-0.0967***</b><br>(0.0139) | <b>-0.0753***</b><br>(0.0173) | <b>-0.0958***</b><br>(0.0139) | <b>-0.0743***</b><br>(0.0174) |
| Capex               | <b>-0.1117***</b><br>(0.0128) | <b>-0.2995***</b><br>(0.0234) | <b>-0.1596***</b><br>(0.0149) | <b>-0.3074***</b><br>(0.0236) | <b>-0.1564***</b><br>(0.0148) | <b>-0.2993***</b><br>(0.0234) | <b>-0.0864***</b><br>(0.0154) | <b>-0.2168***</b><br>(0.0290) | <b>-0.1320***</b><br>(0.0171) | <b>-0.2279***</b><br>(0.0293) | <b>-0.1319***</b><br>(0.0172) | <b>-0.2321***</b><br>(0.0295) |
| DivDummy            | <b>-0.0041***</b><br>(0.0013) | -0.0028<br>(0.0023)           | <b>-0.0054***</b><br>(0.0013) | <b>-0.0041*</b><br>(0.0022)   | <b>-0.0049***</b><br>(0.0013) | -0.0036<br>(0.0022)           | <b>-0.0033*</b><br>(0.0019)   | -0.0056<br>(0.0039)           | -0.0028<br>(0.0019)           | -0.0058<br>(0.0039)           | -0.0030<br>(0.0019)           | -0.0061<br>(0.0039)           |
| sCFO                | <b>0.0066***</b><br>(0.0020)  | -0.0022<br>(0.0014)           | <b>0.0079***</b><br>(0.0030)  | -0.0008<br>(0.0014)           | <b>0.0074***</b><br>(0.0028)  | -0.0009<br>(0.0014)           | <b>0.0112*</b><br>(0.0059)    | 0.0033<br>(0.0022)            | <b>0.0097*</b><br>(0.0051)    | 0.0036<br>(0.0023)            | <b>0.0097*</b><br>(0.0051)    | 0.0036<br>(0.0023)            |
| Lagged_DV           | <b>0.8558***</b><br>(0.0076)  | <b>0.6146***</b><br>(0.0133)  | <b>0.8612***</b><br>(0.0075)  | <b>0.6322***</b><br>(0.0130)  | <b>0.8617***</b><br>(0.0075)  | <b>0.6337***</b><br>(0.0130)  | <b>0.7831***</b><br>(0.0116)  | <b>0.3513***</b><br>(0.0182)  | <b>0.7750***</b><br>(0.0115)  | <b>0.3494***</b><br>(0.0181)  | <b>0.7756***</b><br>(0.0115)  | <b>0.3504***</b><br>(0.0181)  |
| SalesGrowth         |                               |                               | <b>-0.0178***</b><br>(0.0045) | <b>-0.0274***</b><br>(0.0052) | <b>-0.0169***</b><br>(0.0044) | <b>-0.0266***</b><br>(0.0052) |                               |                               | -0.0001<br>(0.0040)           | <b>-0.0065*</b><br>(0.0034)   | 0.0002<br>(0.0040)            | <b>-0.0061*</b><br>(0.0035)   |
| RDSales             |                               |                               | <b>0.0062***</b><br>(0.0017)  | <b>-0.0032***</b><br>(0.0012) | <b>0.0062***</b><br>(0.0017)  | <b>-0.0031**</b><br>(0.0012)  |                               |                               | <b>0.0102***</b><br>(0.0022)  | -0.0002<br>(0.0016)           | <b>0.0102***</b><br>(0.0022)  | -0.0000<br>(0.0016)           |
| CashFlowAt          |                               |                               | <b>0.1292***</b><br>(0.0162)  | <b>0.1589***</b><br>(0.0173)  | <b>0.1278***</b><br>(0.0162)  | <b>0.1576***</b><br>(0.0173)  |                               |                               | <b>0.0941***</b><br>(0.0164)  | <b>0.1143***</b><br>(0.0211)  | <b>0.0914***</b><br>(0.0164)  | <b>0.1117***</b><br>(0.0212)  |
| DailyVola           |                               |                               | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)            | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>-0.0001*</b><br>(0.0000)   |                               |                               | <b>0.0003***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0003***</b><br>(0.0001)  | 0.0001<br>(0.0001)            |
| Extended Controls   |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| Industry FE         | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               |
| Firm FE             |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |
| Year FE             | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                   | 43,333                        | 43,333                        | 43,316                        | 43,316                        | 43,316                        | 43,316                        | 41,853                        | 41,853                        | 41,839                        | 41,839                        | 41,839                        | 41,839                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.825                         | 0.431                         | 0.829                         | 0.449                         | 0.830                         | 0.449                         | 0.713                         | 0.167                         | 0.715                         | 0.175                         | 0.716                         | 0.175                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.825                         | 0.412                         | 0.829                         | 0.430                         | 0.830                         | 0.430                         | 0.713                         | 0.139                         | 0.715                         | 0.147                         | 0.716                         | 0.146                         |

Notes: \* $p < 0.10$ , \*\* $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\* $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms).  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 2: Cash Holdings: Financial-Constraint Moderation

|                       | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                           | (8)                           |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                       | CashRatio                     |                               |                               |                               | CashRatio_lead                |                               |                               |                               |
| ClarityCEO_c          | <b>-0.0062**</b><br>(0.0034)  | -0.0043<br>(0.0052)           | <b>-0.0059**</b><br>(0.0034)  | -0.0042<br>(0.0052)           | -0.0009<br>(0.0042)           | <b>-0.0168**</b><br>(0.0085)  | -0.0011<br>(0.0042)           | <b>-0.0167**</b><br>(0.0085)  |
| UncResCEO_c           | <b>0.0020**</b><br>(0.0011)   | <b>0.0018**</b><br>(0.0010)   | <b>0.0022**</b><br>(0.0011)   | <b>0.0019**</b><br>(0.0010)   | 0.0008<br>(0.0014)            | 0.0014<br>(0.0013)            | 0.0007<br>(0.0014)            | 0.0013<br>(0.0013)            |
| UncPreCEO_c           | 0.0002<br>(0.0012)            | 0.0005<br>(0.0012)            | 0.0003<br>(0.0012)            | 0.0007<br>(0.0012)            | -0.0015<br>(0.0018)           | -0.0006<br>(0.0016)           | -0.0017<br>(0.0018)           | -0.0008<br>(0.0017)           |
| Unrated               | <b>0.0038***</b><br>(0.0012)  | -0.0027<br>(0.0035)           | -0.0010<br>(0.0016)           | -0.0026<br>(0.0035)           | <b>0.0064***</b><br>(0.0020)  | <b>-0.0089*</b><br>(0.0046)   | 0.0000<br>(0.0026)            | <b>-0.0091**</b><br>(0.0046)  |
| UncResCEO_c.x.Unrated | 0.0011<br>(0.0021)            | -0.0001<br>(0.0020)           | 0.0012<br>(0.0021)            | -0.0000<br>(0.0020)           | <b>0.0041*</b><br>(0.0027)    | 0.0031<br>(0.0025)            | <b>0.0040*</b><br>(0.0026)    | 0.0031<br>(0.0024)            |
| UncPreCEO_c.x.Unrated | 0.0024<br>(0.0022)            | 0.0013<br>(0.0025)            | <b>0.0029*</b><br>(0.0023)    | 0.0014<br>(0.0025)            | -0.0011<br>(0.0033)           | -0.0036<br>(0.0033)           | -0.0010<br>(0.0033)           | -0.0038<br>(0.0033)           |
| Leverage              | <b>-0.0117***</b><br>(0.0033) | <b>-0.0216**</b><br>(0.0098)  | <b>-0.0141***</b><br>(0.0041) | <b>-0.0214**</b><br>(0.0099)  | <b>-0.0230**</b><br>(0.0102)  | -0.0073<br>(0.0114)           | <b>-0.0256**</b><br>(0.0112)  | -0.0068<br>(0.0113)           |
| InAssets              | <b>0.0005*</b><br>(0.0003)    | <b>-0.0159***</b><br>(0.0027) | <b>-0.0019***</b><br>(0.0007) | <b>-0.0155***</b><br>(0.0027) | <b>0.0019***</b><br>(0.0005)  | <b>-0.0226***</b><br>(0.0038) | <b>-0.0015*</b><br>(0.0009)   | <b>-0.0229***</b><br>(0.0038) |
| TobinsQ               | <b>0.0047***</b><br>(0.0008)  | <b>0.0045***</b><br>(0.0011)  | <b>0.0041***</b><br>(0.0008)  | <b>0.0040***</b><br>(0.0011)  | <b>0.0047***</b><br>(0.0012)  | -0.0003<br>(0.0015)           | <b>0.0043***</b><br>(0.0012)  | 0.0000<br>(0.0015)            |
| ROA                   | <b>-0.0715***</b><br>(0.0122) | -0.0157<br>(0.0122)           | <b>-0.0651***</b><br>(0.0122) | -0.0133<br>(0.0122)           | <b>-0.0966***</b><br>(0.0146) | <b>-0.0800***</b><br>(0.0181) | <b>-0.0943***</b><br>(0.0146) | <b>-0.0791***</b><br>(0.0182) |
| Capex                 | <b>-0.1610***</b><br>(0.0158) | <b>-0.3087***</b><br>(0.0254) | <b>-0.1647***</b><br>(0.0158) | <b>-0.3005***</b><br>(0.0251) | <b>-0.1206***</b><br>(0.0176) | <b>-0.2327***</b><br>(0.0307) | <b>-0.1304***</b><br>(0.0179) | <b>-0.2373***</b><br>(0.0309) |
| DivDummy              | <b>-0.0058***</b><br>(0.0013) | <b>-0.0043*</b><br>(0.0023)   | <b>-0.0054***</b><br>(0.0013) | -0.0038<br>(0.0023)           | -0.0023<br>(0.0020)           | -0.0049<br>(0.0039)           | -0.0028<br>(0.0020)           | -0.0051<br>(0.0039)           |
| sCFO                  | <b>0.0081***</b><br>(0.0031)  | -0.0003<br>(0.0016)           | <b>0.0072***</b><br>(0.0026)  | -0.0005<br>(0.0016)           | <b>0.0085*</b><br>(0.0043)    | <b>0.0044*</b><br>(0.0024)    | <b>0.0081**</b><br>(0.0039)   | <b>0.0043*</b><br>(0.0023)    |
| SalesGrowth           | <b>-0.0189***</b><br>(0.0045) | <b>-0.0297***</b><br>(0.0048) | <b>-0.0176***</b><br>(0.0044) | <b>-0.0287***</b><br>(0.0048) | -0.0006<br>(0.0047)           | -0.0053<br>(0.0036)           | -0.0004<br>(0.0047)           | -0.0049<br>(0.0036)           |
| RDSales               | <b>0.0089***</b><br>(0.0020)  | -0.0018<br>(0.0015)           | <b>0.0090***</b><br>(0.0020)  | -0.0016<br>(0.0015)           | <b>0.0112***</b><br>(0.0027)  | 0.0002<br>(0.0020)            | <b>0.0114***</b><br>(0.0027)  | 0.0003<br>(0.0021)            |
| CashFlowAt            | <b>0.1415***</b><br>(0.0166)  | <b>0.1741***</b><br>(0.0180)  | <b>0.1368***</b><br>(0.0165)  | <b>0.1729***</b><br>(0.0180)  | <b>0.0989***</b><br>(0.0172)  | <b>0.1233***</b><br>(0.0220)  | <b>0.0926***</b><br>(0.0173)  | <b>0.1205***</b><br>(0.0221)  |
| DailyVola             | <b>0.0001**</b><br>(0.0000)   | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>0.0001**</b><br>(0.0000)   | -0.0001<br>(0.0000)           | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0001)  | 0.0001<br>(0.0001)            |
| Lagged_DV             | <b>0.8605***</b><br>(0.0079)  | <b>0.6188***</b><br>(0.0133)  | <b>0.8571***</b><br>(0.0080)  | <b>0.6204***</b><br>(0.0134)  | <b>0.7807***</b><br>(0.0118)  | <b>0.3351***</b><br>(0.0174)  | <b>0.7762***</b><br>(0.0120)  | <b>0.3365***</b><br>(0.0174)  |
| Industry FE           | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               |
| Firm FE               |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |
| Year FE               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE       |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                     | 38,737                        | 38,737                        | 38,737                        | 38,737                        | 38,764                        | 38,764                        | 38,764                        | 38,764                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>        | 0.827                         | 0.432                         | 0.829                         | 0.432                         | 0.713                         | 0.163                         | 0.714                         | 0.164                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup>   | 0.827                         | 0.412                         | 0.828                         | 0.411                         | 0.712                         | 0.134                         | 0.714                         | 0.133                         |

Notes: \* $p < 0.10$ , \*\* $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\* $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). Fiscal years 2002-2016. DWZ Eq.5 decomposition: Clarity = -CEO FE; UncRes = call-level residual.  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 3: Cash Holdings: Cash-Flow-Volatility Moderation

|                         | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           | (7)                           | (8)                           |
|-------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                         | CashRatio                     |                               |                               |                               | CashRatio.Lead                |                               |                               |                               |
| ClarityCEO_c            | <b>-0.0088***</b><br>(0.0034) | -0.0059<br>(0.0047)           | <b>-0.0071**</b><br>(0.0033)  | -0.0058<br>(0.0047)           | -0.0039<br>(0.0040)           | <b>-0.0137**</b><br>(0.0081)  | -0.0026<br>(0.0041)           | <b>-0.0137**</b><br>(0.0081)  |
| UncResCEO_c             | <b>0.0021**</b><br>(0.0011)   | <b>0.0017*</b><br>(0.0010)    | <b>0.0022**</b><br>(0.0011)   | <b>0.0017**</b><br>(0.0010)   | 0.0007<br>(0.0014)            | 0.0009<br>(0.0013)            | 0.0005<br>(0.0014)            | 0.0007<br>(0.0013)            |
| UncPreCEO_c             | 0.0004<br>(0.0011)            | 0.0006<br>(0.0011)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0012)            | 0.0007<br>(0.0012)            | -0.0009<br>(0.0017)           | 0.0000<br>(0.0016)            | -0.0014<br>(0.0018)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0016)           |
| HighCFvol               | -0.0005<br>(0.0012)           | -0.0022<br>(0.0016)           | <b>-0.0028**</b><br>(0.0013)  | -0.0023<br>(0.0016)           | <b>0.0092***</b><br>(0.0016)  | 0.0028<br>(0.0022)            | <b>0.0075***</b><br>(0.0017)  | 0.0029<br>(0.0022)            |
| UncResCEO_c.x.HighCFvol | 0.0004<br>(0.0020)            | 0.0004<br>(0.0019)            | -0.0000<br>(0.0020)           | 0.0002<br>(0.0019)            | <b>0.0039*</b><br>(0.0027)    | 0.0025<br>(0.0024)            | <b>0.0040*</b><br>(0.0027)    | 0.0027<br>(0.0024)            |
| UncPreCEO_c.x.HighCFvol | <b>0.0048**</b><br>(0.0022)   | 0.0002<br>(0.0024)            | <b>0.0049**</b><br>(0.0022)   | 0.0002<br>(0.0024)            | <b>0.0060**</b><br>(0.0033)   | 0.0035<br>(0.0035)            | <b>0.0061**</b><br>(0.0033)   | 0.0036<br>(0.0035)            |
| Leverage                | <b>-0.0127***</b><br>(0.0034) | <b>-0.0191**</b><br>(0.0082)  | <b>-0.0130***</b><br>(0.0036) | <b>-0.0189**</b><br>(0.0082)  | <b>-0.0270***</b><br>(0.0096) | -0.0089<br>(0.0106)           | <b>-0.0267***</b><br>(0.0096) | -0.0083<br>(0.0106)           |
| InAssets                | 0.0004<br>(0.0003)            | <b>-0.0174***</b><br>(0.0026) | <b>-0.0015***</b><br>(0.0006) | <b>-0.0169***</b><br>(0.0026) | <b>0.0015***</b><br>(0.0005)  | <b>-0.0179***</b><br>(0.0037) | -0.0006<br>(0.0008)           | <b>-0.0180***</b><br>(0.0037) |
| TobinsQ                 | <b>0.0044***</b><br>(0.0008)  | <b>0.0037***</b><br>(0.0011)  | <b>0.0035***</b><br>(0.0008)  | <b>0.0034***</b><br>(0.0011)  | <b>0.0055***</b><br>(0.0012)  | 0.0005<br>(0.0016)            | <b>0.0049***</b><br>(0.0012)  | 0.0007<br>(0.0016)            |
| ROA                     | <b>-0.0641***</b><br>(0.0117) | -0.0148<br>(0.0123)           | <b>-0.0563***</b><br>(0.0116) | -0.0121<br>(0.0123)           | <b>-0.0985***</b><br>(0.0149) | <b>-0.0733***</b><br>(0.0184) | <b>-0.0964***</b><br>(0.0149) | <b>-0.0726***</b><br>(0.0186) |
| Capex                   | <b>-0.1692***</b><br>(0.0158) | <b>-0.3164***</b><br>(0.0251) | <b>-0.1779***</b><br>(0.0160) | <b>-0.3085***</b><br>(0.0249) | <b>-0.1159***</b><br>(0.0175) | <b>-0.2361***</b><br>(0.0313) | <b>-0.1275***</b><br>(0.0177) | <b>-0.2400***</b><br>(0.0314) |
| DivDummy                | <b>-0.0057***</b><br>(0.0013) | <b>-0.0051**</b><br>(0.0023)  | <b>-0.0054***</b><br>(0.0013) | <b>-0.0046**</b><br>(0.0023)  | -0.0013<br>(0.0019)           | -0.0063<br>(0.0041)           | -0.0017<br>(0.0020)           | -0.0065<br>(0.0041)           |
| sCFO                    | <b>0.0087**</b><br>(0.0043)   | 0.0004<br>(0.0017)            | <b>0.0078**</b><br>(0.0037)   | 0.0003<br>(0.0017)            | 0.0084<br>(0.0055)            | <b>0.0043*</b><br>(0.0026)    | 0.0083<br>(0.0053)            | <b>0.0043*</b><br>(0.0026)    |
| SalesGrowth             | <b>-0.0203***</b><br>(0.0050) | <b>-0.0291***</b><br>(0.0057) | <b>-0.0192***</b><br>(0.0049) | <b>-0.0283***</b><br>(0.0057) | 0.0003<br>(0.0042)            | <b>-0.0070*</b><br>(0.0037)   | 0.0006<br>(0.0043)            | <b>-0.0066*</b><br>(0.0037)   |
| RDSales                 | <b>0.0063***</b><br>(0.0022)  | <b>-0.0031**</b><br>(0.0015)  | <b>0.0063***</b><br>(0.0022)  | <b>-0.0029**</b><br>(0.0015)  | <b>0.0109***</b><br>(0.0029)  | -0.0006<br>(0.0025)           | <b>0.0110***</b><br>(0.0029)  | -0.0006<br>(0.0026)           |
| CashFlowAt              | <b>0.1476***</b><br>(0.0170)  | <b>0.1713***</b><br>(0.0179)  | <b>0.1382***</b><br>(0.0171)  | <b>0.1698***</b><br>(0.0179)  | <b>0.1015***</b><br>(0.0181)  | <b>0.1107***</b><br>(0.0225)  | <b>0.0926***</b><br>(0.0183)  | <b>0.1082***</b><br>(0.0227)  |
| DailyVola               | <b>0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>-0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000)  | -0.0001<br>(0.0000)           | <b>0.0004***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0001)  | 0.0001<br>(0.0001)            |
| Lagged_DV               | <b>0.8664***</b><br>(0.0077)  | <b>0.6307***</b><br>(0.0133)  | <b>0.8619***</b><br>(0.0078)  | <b>0.6322***</b><br>(0.0133)  | <b>0.7796***</b><br>(0.0119)  | <b>0.3488***</b><br>(0.0182)  | <b>0.7752***</b><br>(0.0121)  | <b>0.3498***</b><br>(0.0182)  |
| Industry FE             | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               |
| Firm FE                 |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |
| Year FE                 | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE         |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                       | 40,795                        | 40,795                        | 40,795                        | 40,795                        | 39,207                        | 39,207                        | 39,207                        | 39,207                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>          | 0.825                         | 0.447                         | 0.826                         | 0.447                         | 0.708                         | 0.171                         | 0.709                         | 0.171                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup>     | 0.824                         | 0.429                         | 0.826                         | 0.428                         | 0.707                         | 0.143                         | 0.708                         | 0.142                         |

Notes: \* $p < 0.10$ , \*\* $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\* $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). Fiscal years 2002-2018. Full panel coverage via Compustat Quarterly OCF Extended (1990-2002 backfill); Han-Qiu 16-trailing-quarter CFvol available from 1994-Q1 onwards in source data.  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 4: Political Risk and Call Uncertainty

|             | (1)                          | (2)                           | (3)                          | (4)                          |
|-------------|------------------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|
|             | Industry FE                  |                               | Firm FE                      |                              |
|             | UncResCEO                    | UncPreCEO                     | UncResCEO                    | UncPreCEO                    |
| PRisk       | <b>0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>0.0003***</b><br>(0.0000)  | <b>0.0001***</b><br>(0.0000) | <b>0.0002***</b><br>(0.0000) |
| UncQue      | -0.0022<br>(0.0032)          | <b>0.0204***</b><br>(0.0045)  | -0.0014<br>(0.0037)          | <b>0.0081***</b><br>(0.0029) |
| NegCall     | -0.0025<br>(0.0051)          | <b>0.1874***</b><br>(0.0141)  | -0.0036<br>(0.0073)          | <b>0.1477***</b><br>(0.0082) |
| lnAssets    | -0.0002<br>(0.0004)          | <b>-0.0296***</b><br>(0.0039) | -0.0054<br>(0.0058)          | 0.0048<br>(0.0078)           |
| TobinsQ     | -0.0005<br>(0.0009)          | -0.0007<br>(0.0036)           | -0.0008<br>(0.0022)          | 0.0001<br>(0.0023)           |
| ROA         | <b>0.0291**</b><br>(0.0145)  | 0.0477<br>(0.0318)            | <b>0.0540**</b><br>(0.0264)  | 0.0346<br>(0.0230)           |
| CashRatio   | 0.0019<br>(0.0077)           | -0.0354<br>(0.0357)           | 0.0206<br>(0.0240)           | 0.0265<br>(0.0287)           |
| DivDummy    | -0.0031<br>(0.0021)          | -0.0139<br>(0.0118)           | -0.0108<br>(0.0074)          | <b>-0.0229**</b><br>(0.0103) |
| FirmMat     | 0.0012<br>(0.0013)           | <b>0.0021**</b><br>(0.0010)   | 0.0027<br>(0.0041)           | 0.0006<br>(0.0007)           |
| EarnVol     | 0.0078<br>(0.0077)           | -0.0072<br>(0.0157)           | 0.0056<br>(0.0117)           | -0.0104<br>(0.0132)          |
| UncPreCEO   | -0.0051<br>(0.0034)          |                               | -0.0054<br>(0.0054)          |                              |
| Industry FE | Yes                          | Yes                           |                              |                              |
| Firm FE     |                              |                               | Yes                          | Yes                          |
| Year FE     | Yes                          | Yes                           | Yes                          | Yes                          |
| N           | 44,497                       | 65,760                        | 44,497                       | 65,760                       |
| $R^2$       | 0.003                        | 0.043                         | 0.003                        | 0.023                        |
| Adj. $R^2$  | 0.002                        | 0.043                         | -0.030                       | -0.004                       |

Notes: \* $p < 0.10$ , \*\* $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\* $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). Firms with fewer than 5 calls are excluded.  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 5: Political Risk and Call Uncertainty (Two-Quarter Lag)

|             | (1)                         | (2)                            | (3)                          | (4)                           |
|-------------|-----------------------------|--------------------------------|------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|             | Industry FE                 |                                | Firm FE                      |                               |
|             | UncResCEO                   | UncPreCEO                      | UncResCEO                    | UncPreCEO                     |
| PRisk_lag2  | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)          | <b>0.0001</b> ***<br>(0.0000)  | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)           | <b>0.0000</b> ***<br>(0.0000) |
| UncQue      | 0.0001<br>(0.0033)          | <b>0.0242</b> ***<br>(0.0047)  | 0.0010<br>(0.0038)           | <b>0.0099</b> ***<br>(0.0031) |
| NegCall     | 0.0020<br>(0.0052)          | <b>0.2019</b> ***<br>(0.0145)  | 0.0019<br>(0.0074)           | <b>0.1609</b> ***<br>(0.0084) |
| lnAssets    | -0.0001<br>(0.0005)         | <b>-0.0298</b> ***<br>(0.0040) | -0.0035<br>(0.0062)          | 0.0047<br>(0.0078)            |
| TobinsQ     | -0.0005<br>(0.0010)         | -0.0002<br>(0.0037)            | -0.0011<br>(0.0023)          | -0.0002<br>(0.0023)           |
| ROA         | <b>0.0293</b> *<br>(0.0152) | 0.0518<br>(0.0331)             | <b>0.0598</b> **<br>(0.0272) | <b>0.0464</b> *<br>(0.0247)   |
| CashRatio   | 0.0064<br>(0.0076)          | -0.0400<br>(0.0368)            | 0.0170<br>(0.0242)           | 0.0233<br>(0.0292)            |
| DivDummy    | -0.0031<br>(0.0022)         | -0.0142<br>(0.0121)            | <b>-0.0133</b> *<br>(0.0076) | <b>-0.0207</b> *<br>(0.0106)  |
| FirmMat     | 0.0013<br>(0.0013)          | 0.0021<br>(0.0015)             | 0.0025<br>(0.0041)           | -0.0007<br>(0.0016)           |
| EarnVol     | 0.0096<br>(0.0063)          | -0.0078<br>(0.0159)            | 0.0089<br>(0.0100)           | -0.0154<br>(0.0158)           |
| UncPreCEO   | -0.0001<br>(0.0035)         |                                | -0.0003<br>(0.0056)          |                               |
| Industry FE | Yes                         | Yes                            |                              |                               |
| Firm FE     |                             |                                | Yes                          | Yes                           |
| Year FE     | Yes                         | Yes                            | Yes                          | Yes                           |
| N           | 43,037                      | 63,022                         | 43,037                       | 63,022                        |
| $R^2$       | 0.000                       | 0.035                          | 0.000                        | 0.015                         |
| Adj. $R^2$  | -0.001                      | 0.034                          | -0.033                       | -0.013                        |

Notes: \* $p < 0.10$ , \*\* $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\* $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). Firms with fewer than 5 calls are excluded.  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 6: Product-Market Competition and Call Uncertainty

|                       | (1)                         | (2)                           | (3)                         | (4)                          |
|-----------------------|-----------------------------|-------------------------------|-----------------------------|------------------------------|
|                       | Industry FE                 |                               | Firm FE                     |                              |
|                       | UncResCEO                   | UncPreCEO                     | UncResCEO                   | UncPreCEO                    |
| z_log_TotalSimilarity | 0.0008<br>(0.0014)          | <b>0.0304***</b><br>(0.0074)  | 0.0023<br>(0.0075)          | <b>0.0302***</b><br>(0.0093) |
| UncQue                | 0.0011<br>(0.0062)          | <b>0.0398***</b><br>(0.0100)  | 0.0039<br>(0.0087)          | 0.0084<br>(0.0073)           |
| NegCall               | 0.0020<br>(0.0068)          | <b>0.2340***</b><br>(0.0201)  | 0.0046<br>(0.0120)          | <b>0.1698***</b><br>(0.0140) |
| lnAssets              | -0.0007<br>(0.0007)         | <b>-0.0335***</b><br>(0.0038) | -0.0101<br>(0.0071)         | 0.0013<br>(0.0081)           |
| TobinsQ               | 0.0001<br>(0.0013)          | -0.0007<br>(0.0037)           | 0.0009<br>(0.0025)          | -0.0017<br>(0.0025)          |
| ROA                   | 0.0233<br>(0.0197)          | <b>0.0681**</b><br>(0.0314)   | 0.0343<br>(0.0308)          | 0.0241<br>(0.0254)           |
| CashRatio             | 0.0065<br>(0.0103)          | <b>-0.0803**</b><br>(0.0360)  | 0.0055<br>(0.0287)          | 0.0022<br>(0.0306)           |
| DivDummy              | -0.0020<br>(0.0028)         | -0.0060<br>(0.0117)           | -0.0074<br>(0.0083)         | -0.0166<br>(0.0106)          |
| FirmMat               | 0.0018<br>(0.0019)          | <b>0.0014**</b><br>(0.0007)   | 0.0083<br>(0.0056)          | 0.0003<br>(0.0004)           |
| EarnVol               | -0.0047<br>(0.0087)         | -0.0210<br>(0.0152)           | -0.0048<br>(0.0121)         | -0.0114<br>(0.0146)          |
| UncPreCEO             | <b>0.0111**</b><br>(0.0044) |                               | <b>0.0230**</b><br>(0.0093) |                              |
| Industry FE           | Yes                         | Yes                           |                             |                              |
| Firm FE               |                             |                               | Yes                         | Yes                          |
| Year FE               | Yes                         | Yes                           | Yes                         | Yes                          |
| N                     | 12,728                      | 18,492                        | 12,728                      | 18,492                       |
| R <sup>2</sup>        | 0.001                       | 0.050                         | 0.001                       | 0.021                        |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup>   | -0.002                      | 0.048                         | -0.098                      | -0.068                       |

Notes: \* $p < 0.10$ , \*\* $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\* $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). Unit of observation: firm-fiscal-year.  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 7: US Policy Uncertainty and Call Uncertainty

|                     | (1)<br>Industry + Cal. Year FE | (2)<br>Industry + Cal. Year FE | (3)<br>Firm + Cal. Year FE   | (4)<br>Firm + Cal. Year FE   |
|---------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|
|                     | UncResCEO                      | UncPreCEO                      | UncResCEO                    | UncPreCEO                    |
| US_EPU_log          | <b>0.0124**</b><br>(0.0075)    | <b>0.0211***</b><br>(0.0074)   | <b>0.0123*</b><br>(0.0075)   | <b>0.0239***</b><br>(0.0076) |
| UncQue              | 0.0011<br>(0.0035)             | <b>0.0164***</b><br>(0.0032)   | 0.0024<br>(0.0040)           | <b>0.0095***</b><br>(0.0028) |
| NegCall             | 0.0006<br>(0.0056)             | <b>0.1247***</b><br>(0.0089)   | 0.0021<br>(0.0073)           | <b>0.1385***</b><br>(0.0079) |
| InAssets            | 0.0009<br>(0.0007)             | <b>-0.0143***</b><br>(0.0020)  | 0.0013<br>(0.0067)           | 0.0038<br>(0.0063)           |
| TobinsQ             | -0.0001<br>(0.0011)            | 0.0007<br>(0.0019)             | -0.0000<br>(0.0027)          | 0.0007<br>(0.0018)           |
| ROA                 | <b>0.0281*</b><br>(0.0149)     | <b>0.0367**</b><br>(0.0168)    | <b>0.0677**</b><br>(0.0268)  | <b>0.0467**</b><br>(0.0191)  |
| CashRatio           | 0.0051<br>(0.0087)             | -0.0079<br>(0.0187)            | 0.0345<br>(0.0256)           | 0.0305<br>(0.0231)           |
| DivDummy            | <b>-0.0046***</b><br>(0.0009)  | -0.0074<br>(0.0061)            | <b>-0.0142**</b><br>(0.0072) | <b>-0.0157*</b><br>(0.0083)  |
| FirmMat             | <b>0.0023*</b><br>(0.0012)     | 0.0009<br>(0.0008)             | 0.0005<br>(0.0047)           | -0.0011<br>(0.0012)          |
| EarnVol             | <b>0.0268*</b><br>(0.0157)     | -0.0074<br>(0.0086)            | <b>0.0353**</b><br>(0.0176)  | -0.0083<br>(0.0119)          |
| UncPreCEO           | -0.0026<br>(0.0032)            |                                | -0.0011<br>(0.0045)          |                              |
| Lagged_DV           | <b>0.0202***</b><br>(0.0054)   | <b>0.5176***</b><br>(0.0131)   | <b>0.0187***</b><br>(0.0056) | <b>0.2626***</b><br>(0.0089) |
| Industry FE         | Yes                            | Yes                            |                              |                              |
| Firm FE             |                                |                                | Yes                          | Yes                          |
| Year FE             | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                          | Yes                          |
| N                   | 39,063                         | 60,503                         | 39,063                       | 60,503                       |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.001                          | 0.292                          | 0.001                        | 0.084                        |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | -0.000                         | 0.291                          | -0.035                       | 0.057                        |

Notes: \* $p < 0.10$ , \*\* $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\* $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) two-way clustered (firm, calendar quarter). Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). Firms with fewer than 5 calls are excluded.  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 8: Global Policy Uncertainty and Call Uncertainty

|                     | (1)<br>Industry + Cal. Year FE | (2)<br>Industry + Cal. Year FE | (3)<br>Firm + Cal. Year FE   | (4)<br>Firm + Cal. Year FE   |
|---------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|
|                     | UncResCEO                      | UncPreCEO                      | UncResCEO                    | UncPreCEO                    |
| GEPU_log            | <b>0.0181**</b><br>(0.0100)    | <b>0.0271***</b><br>(0.0107)   | <b>0.0187**</b><br>(0.0101)  | <b>0.0309***</b><br>(0.0108) |
| UncQue              | 0.0011<br>(0.0035)             | <b>0.0164***</b><br>(0.0032)   | 0.0024<br>(0.0039)           | <b>0.0095***</b><br>(0.0028) |
| NegCall             | 0.0006<br>(0.0056)             | <b>0.1247***</b><br>(0.0089)   | 0.0020<br>(0.0072)           | <b>0.1385***</b><br>(0.0079) |
| lnAssets            | 0.0009<br>(0.0007)             | <b>-0.0143***</b><br>(0.0020)  | 0.0012<br>(0.0067)           | 0.0037<br>(0.0063)           |
| TobinsQ             | -0.0001<br>(0.0011)            | 0.0008<br>(0.0019)             | 0.0000<br>(0.0027)           | 0.0007<br>(0.0018)           |
| ROA                 | <b>0.0280*</b><br>(0.0149)     | <b>0.0367**</b><br>(0.0168)    | <b>0.0673**</b><br>(0.0267)  | <b>0.0462**</b><br>(0.0191)  |
| CashRatio           | 0.0051<br>(0.0087)             | -0.0080<br>(0.0188)            | 0.0345<br>(0.0256)           | 0.0304<br>(0.0231)           |
| DivDummy            | <b>-0.0047***</b><br>(0.0009)  | -0.0074<br>(0.0061)            | <b>-0.0142**</b><br>(0.0072) | <b>-0.0156*</b><br>(0.0083)  |
| FirmMat             | <b>0.0023*</b><br>(0.0012)     | 0.0009<br>(0.0008)             | 0.0006<br>(0.0047)           | -0.0011<br>(0.0012)          |
| EarnVol             | <b>0.0269*</b><br>(0.0157)     | -0.0074<br>(0.0086)            | <b>0.0354**</b><br>(0.0176)  | -0.0082<br>(0.0119)          |
| UncPreCEO           | -0.0026<br>(0.0032)            |                                | -0.0011<br>(0.0045)          |                              |
| Lagged_DV           | <b>0.0202***</b><br>(0.0054)   | <b>0.5176***</b><br>(0.0131)   | <b>0.0187***</b><br>(0.0056) | <b>0.2626***</b><br>(0.0089) |
| Industry FE         | Yes                            | Yes                            |                              |                              |
| Firm FE             |                                |                                | Yes                          | Yes                          |
| Year FE             | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                          | Yes                          |
| N                   | 39,063                         | 60,503                         | 39,063                       | 60,503                       |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.001                          | 0.292                          | 0.001                        | 0.084                        |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | -0.000                         | 0.291                          | -0.035                       | 0.057                        |

Notes: \* $p < 0.10$ , \*\* $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\* $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) two-way clustered (firm, calendar quarter). Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). Firms with fewer than 5 calls are excluded.  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).



Table 9: CEO Uncertainty and the Bid-Ask Spread

|                     | (1)                           | (2)                            | (3)                            | (4)                            | (5)                            | (6)                            | (7)                           | (8)                            | (9)                           | (10)                           | (11)                          | (12)                           |
|---------------------|-------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|-------------------------------|--------------------------------|-------------------------------|--------------------------------|-------------------------------|--------------------------------|
|                     |                               |                                | BGTLevel_Spread                |                                |                                |                                |                               |                                | BGTLevel_Spread_lead1         |                                |                               |                                |
| ClarityCEO          | -0.0477<br>(0.2145)           | 1.0617<br>(0.4277)             | 0.2122<br>(0.2227)             | 1.1056<br>(0.4260)             | 0.1644<br>(0.2103)             | 1.0547<br>(0.4174)             | -0.1886<br>(0.2370)           | 0.5998<br>(0.4004)             | -0.0922<br>(0.2399)           | 0.6828<br>(0.4055)             | -0.0431<br>(0.2206)           | 0.5722<br>(0.3729)             |
| UncResCEO           | -0.0594<br>(0.1068)           | -0.0687<br>(0.1057)            | -0.0882<br>(0.1023)            | -0.1021<br>(0.1007)            | -0.0757<br>(0.0994)            | -0.0893<br>(0.0981)            | 0.0825<br>(0.1416)            | 0.0696<br>(0.1437)             | 0.0742<br>(0.1407)            | 0.0545<br>(0.1426)             | 0.0984<br>(0.1339)            | 0.0751<br>(0.1357)             |
| UncPreCEO           | <b>0.1664**</b><br>(0.0946)   | <b>0.3496***</b><br>(0.1253)   | 0.0814<br>(0.0956)             | <b>0.2945***</b><br>(0.1229)   | 0.0108<br>(0.0919)             | <b>0.1644*</b><br>(0.1184)     | -0.0817<br>(0.0926)           | -0.0288<br>(0.1229)            | -0.1072<br>(0.0926)           | -0.0360<br>(0.1233)            | 0.0170<br>(0.0872)            | 0.1124<br>(0.1186)             |
| lnAssets            | <b>-0.8039***</b><br>(0.0490) | <b>-1.9098***</b><br>(0.2000)  | <b>-0.6339***</b><br>(0.0472)  | <b>-1.6825***</b><br>(0.2156)  | <b>-0.6352***</b><br>(0.0473)  | <b>-1.8277***</b><br>(0.2158)  | <b>-0.8218***</b><br>(0.0513) | <b>-1.5191***</b><br>(0.1951)  | <b>-0.7857***</b><br>(0.0505) | <b>-1.7292***</b><br>(0.2130)  | <b>-0.6568***</b><br>(0.0474) | <b>-1.4181***</b><br>(0.2017)  |
| TobinsQ             | <b>-0.2861***</b><br>(0.0457) | <b>-0.4785***</b><br>(0.0900)  | <b>-0.2633***</b><br>(0.0470)  | <b>-0.5518***</b><br>(0.0963)  | <b>-0.2654***</b><br>(0.0451)  | <b>-0.5883***</b><br>(0.0956)  | <b>-0.2305***</b><br>(0.0467) | <b>-0.3215***</b><br>(0.0850)  | <b>-0.2285***</b><br>(0.0478) | <b>-0.4803***</b><br>(0.1002)  | <b>-0.2035***</b><br>(0.0433) | <b>-0.4289***</b><br>(0.0935)  |
| ROA                 | <b>-9.4469***</b><br>(1.0201) | <b>-11.6430***</b><br>(1.3867) | <b>-5.7059***</b><br>(0.9822)  | <b>-7.6844***</b><br>(1.2654)  | <b>-5.7511***</b><br>(0.9633)  | <b>-7.8517***</b><br>(1.2490)  | <b>-9.9256***</b><br>(1.0798) | <b>-12.8443***</b><br>(1.2992) | <b>-8.8744***</b><br>(1.0722) | <b>-11.9197***</b><br>(1.2732) | <b>-7.6375***</b><br>(0.9869) | <b>-10.5867***</b><br>(1.1921) |
| Leverage            | <b>0.3875*</b><br>(0.2088)    | <b>1.8330***</b><br>(0.5143)   | -0.1126<br>(0.2434)            | 0.6850<br>(0.5013)             | -0.0542<br>(0.2264)            | 0.8026<br>(0.4954)             | 0.2924<br>(0.2224)            | 0.5282<br>(0.5516)             | 0.1338<br>(0.2248)            | 0.2221<br>(0.5596)             | 0.0592<br>(0.2111)            | 0.1928<br>(0.5258)             |
| Capex               | -0.8001<br>(1.1109)           | 0.9540<br>(2.9126)             | <b>-2.3622**</b><br>(1.1044)   | -1.5271<br>(2.8061)            | <b>-2.0790*</b><br>(1.0845)    | -1.2897<br>(2.7998)            | <b>-1.6463*</b><br>(0.9620)   | -3.2121<br>(2.2020)            | <b>-2.1561**</b><br>(0.9823)  | <b>-4.3379*</b><br>(2.2446)    | -1.4770<br>(0.9011)           | -2.4356<br>(2.1565)            |
| DivDummy            | 0.1043<br>(0.0893)            | 0.1429<br>(0.2020)             | <b>0.3329***</b><br>(0.0896)   | 0.2549<br>(0.1888)             | <b>0.3156***</b><br>(0.0855)   | 0.2723<br>(0.1867)             | 0.0240<br>(0.0887)            | 0.1007<br>(0.2095)             | 0.1012<br>(0.0889)            | 0.1454<br>(0.2074)             | 0.1145<br>(0.0825)            | 0.1739<br>(0.1975)             |
| sCFO                | <b>0.6700**</b><br>(0.3405)   | <b>0.8405**</b><br>(0.3472)    | 0.4045<br>(0.4604)             | <b>0.6825*</b><br>(0.3789)     | 0.4084<br>(0.4126)             | <b>0.6882**</b><br>(0.3375)    | 0.0871<br>(0.1759)            | <b>0.3644*</b><br>(0.1877)     | 0.0040<br>(0.2174)            | 0.3165<br>(0.2055)             | -0.0840<br>(0.1937)           | 0.2479<br>(0.1738)             |
| Lagged_DV           | <b>0.7547***</b><br>(0.0150)  | <b>0.6569***</b><br>(0.0186)   | <b>0.7140***</b><br>(0.0167)   | <b>0.6180***</b><br>(0.0199)   | <b>0.7310***</b><br>(0.0168)   | <b>0.6318***</b><br>(0.0208)   | <b>0.7540***</b><br>(0.0156)  | <b>0.6361***</b><br>(0.0185)   | <b>0.7360***</b><br>(0.0173)  | <b>0.6135***</b><br>(0.0205)   | <b>0.7676***</b><br>(0.0162)  | <b>0.6518***</b><br>(0.0197)   |
| StockPrice          |                               |                                | -0.0011<br>(0.0014)            | -0.0033<br>(0.0024)            | 0.0002<br>(0.0013)             | 0.0019<br>(0.0024)             |                               |                                | -0.0001<br>(0.0013)           | <b>0.0101***</b><br>(0.0024)   | -0.0016<br>(0.0012)           | <b>0.0047**</b><br>(0.0022)    |
| Turnover            |                               |                                | <b>-24.1012***</b><br>(1.7508) | <b>-23.8647***</b><br>(2.2119) | <b>-20.7840***</b><br>(1.7290) | <b>-20.3411***</b><br>(2.1791) |                               |                                | <b>-7.9396***</b><br>(1.5411) | <b>-5.5050***</b><br>(2.0904)  | <b>-7.1303***</b><br>(1.4699) | <b>-4.7073**</b><br>(1.9633)   |
| DailyVola           |                               |                                | <b>0.1229***</b><br>(0.0072)   | <b>0.1393***</b><br>(0.0081)   | <b>0.1075***</b><br>(0.0082)   | <b>0.1257***</b><br>(0.0099)   |                               |                                | <b>0.0404***</b><br>(0.0062)  | <b>0.0520***</b><br>(0.0068)   | <b>0.0396***</b><br>(0.0069)  | <b>0.0441***</b><br>(0.0081)   |
| AbsSurpDec          |                               |                                | <b>-0.0919***</b><br>(0.0265)  | -0.0241<br>(0.0300)            | <b>-0.0756***</b><br>(0.0253)  | -0.0093<br>(0.0286)            |                               |                                | -0.0050<br>(0.0278)           | 0.0119<br>(0.0304)             | -0.0174<br>(0.0261)           | -0.0012<br>(0.0285)            |
| Extended Controls   |                               |                                | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                            |                               |                                | Yes                           | Yes                            | Yes                           | Yes                            |
| Industry FE         | Yes                           |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                           |                                | Yes                           |                                | Yes                           |                                |
| Firm FE             |                               | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                                | Yes                            |                               | Yes                            |                               | Yes                            |                               | Yes                            |
| Year FE             | Yes                           | Yes                            | Yes                            | Yes                            |                                |                                | Yes                           | Yes                            | Yes                           | Yes                            |                               |                                |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                               |                                |                                |                                | Yes                            | Yes                            |                               |                                |                               |                                | Yes                           | Yes                            |
| N                   | 42,625                        | 42,625                         | 42,625                         | 42,625                         | 42,625                         | 42,625                         | 43,049                        | 43,049                         | 43,049                        | 43,049                         | 43,049                        | 43,049                         |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.703                         | 0.517                          | 0.721                          | 0.551                          | 0.730                          | 0.548                          | 0.700                         | 0.499                          | 0.702                         | 0.504                          | 0.723                         | 0.523                          |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | 0.703                         | 0.501                          | 0.721                          | 0.535                          | 0.730                          | 0.532                          | 0.700                         | 0.482                          | 0.702                         | 0.487                          | 0.723                         | 0.506                          |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). DWZ Full decomposition: Clarity = -CEO FE; UncRes = call-level residual.  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ). Spread<sub>25D</sub> values rescaled by  $10^4$  (basis points) for readability; multiply coefficients by  $10^{-4}$  to recover raw fraction units.

Table 10: CEO Uncertainty and SEC Comment-Letter Receipt

|                     | (1)                           | (2)                           | (3)                           | (4)                           | (5)                           | (6)                           |
|---------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                     | CCCL                          |                               |                               |                               |                               |                               |
| ClarityCEO          | 0.0059<br>(0.0015)            | 0.0039<br>(0.0030)            | 0.0062<br>(0.0015)            | 0.0040<br>(0.0030)            | 0.0058<br>(0.0015)            | 0.0040<br>(0.0030)            |
| UncResCEO           | -0.0003<br>(0.0009)           | -0.0003<br>(0.0009)           | -0.0003<br>(0.0009)           | -0.0003<br>(0.0009)           | -0.0004<br>(0.0009)           | -0.0004<br>(0.0009)           |
| UncPreCEO           | 0.0008<br>(0.0008)            | <b>0.0014*</b><br>(0.0009)    | <b>0.0016**</b><br>(0.0007)   | <b>0.0014*</b><br>(0.0009)    | 0.0007<br>(0.0008)            | <b>0.0013*</b><br>(0.0009)    |
| lnAssets            | <b>-0.0006**</b><br>(0.0002)  | <b>0.0018*</b><br>(0.0011)    | 0.0001<br>(0.0001)            | 0.0017<br>(0.0010)            | <b>-0.0006**</b><br>(0.0003)  | <b>0.0019*</b><br>(0.0011)    |
| TobinsQ             | -0.0003<br>(0.0003)           | 0.0002<br>(0.0004)            | -0.0001<br>(0.0003)           | 0.0002<br>(0.0004)            | -0.0002<br>(0.0003)           | 0.0004<br>(0.0004)            |
| ROA                 | 0.0006<br>(0.0034)            | 0.0012<br>(0.0052)            | -0.0014<br>(0.0052)           | -0.0006<br>(0.0062)           | -0.0006<br>(0.0051)           | -0.0004<br>(0.0062)           |
| Leverage            | -0.0008<br>(0.0015)           | -0.0019<br>(0.0034)           | -0.0009<br>(0.0015)           | -0.0011<br>(0.0035)           | -0.0009<br>(0.0015)           | -0.0012<br>(0.0035)           |
| Capex               | -0.0029<br>(0.0063)           | 0.0106<br>(0.0104)            | 0.0004<br>(0.0064)            | 0.0111<br>(0.0104)            | -0.0033<br>(0.0066)           | 0.0107<br>(0.0103)            |
| CashRatio           | -0.0014<br>(0.0027)           | <b>-0.0075*</b><br>(0.0044)   | 0.0009<br>(0.0026)            | <b>-0.0080*</b><br>(0.0044)   | -0.0014<br>(0.0028)           | <b>-0.0082*</b><br>(0.0044)   |
| DivDummy            | -0.0005<br>(0.0008)           | 0.0003<br>(0.0015)            | -0.0005<br>(0.0008)           | 0.0002<br>(0.0015)            | -0.0005<br>(0.0008)           | 0.0002<br>(0.0015)            |
| sCFO                | -0.0007<br>(0.0005)           | -0.0020<br>(0.0024)           | -0.0004<br>(0.0004)           | -0.0019<br>(0.0024)           | -0.0007<br>(0.0005)           | -0.0019<br>(0.0024)           |
| Lagged_DV           | <b>-0.0079***</b><br>(0.0008) | <b>-0.0409***</b><br>(0.0027) | <b>-0.0077***</b><br>(0.0007) | <b>-0.0410***</b><br>(0.0027) | <b>-0.0074***</b><br>(0.0008) | <b>-0.0405***</b><br>(0.0028) |
| SalesGrowth         |                               |                               | -0.0002<br>(0.0008)           | -0.0013<br>(0.0011)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0008)           | -0.0011<br>(0.0011)           |
| RDSales             |                               |                               | -0.0003<br>(0.0002)           | -0.0002<br>(0.0002)           | -0.0003<br>(0.0002)           | -0.0001<br>(0.0002)           |
| CashFlowAt          |                               |                               | 0.0025<br>(0.0050)            | 0.0043<br>(0.0064)            | 0.0009<br>(0.0050)            | 0.0037<br>(0.0064)            |
| DailyVola           |                               |                               | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)            | <b>-0.0000*</b><br>(0.0000)   | 0.0000<br>(0.0000)            | -0.0000<br>(0.0000)           |
| Extended Controls   |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| Industry FE         | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               |
| Firm FE             |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |                               | Yes                           |
| Year FE             | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           |                               |                               |
| Year-Quarter FE     |                               |                               |                               |                               | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| N                   | 44,113                        | 44,113                        | 44,096                        | 44,096                        | 44,096                        | 44,096                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.001                         | 0.002                         | 0.000                         | 0.002                         | 0.001                         | 0.002                         |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup> | -0.000                        | -0.032                        | -0.001                        | -0.032                        | -0.001                        | -0.033                        |

Notes: \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for IVs,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). DWZ Full decomposition: Clarity = -CEO FE; UncRes = call-level residual.  $R^2$  includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- $R^2$ ).

Table 11: Campello Brexit Replication Suite

|                                              | CASH (eq. 14)                  |                               | CASH (PSM)                     |                              | UncRes                         |                             | UncRes (PSM)                   |                            | UncRes <sub>≥m</sub>           |                             | UncRes <sub>≥m</sub> (PSM)      |                             | Campello T.8                 |                              |
|----------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|-------------------------------|--------------------------------|------------------------------|--------------------------------|-----------------------------|--------------------------------|----------------------------|--------------------------------|-----------------------------|---------------------------------|-----------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|
|                                              | (1)<br>$\beta^{UK}$<br>tercile | (2)<br>textual<br>Item 1+7    | (3)<br>$\beta^{UK}$<br>tercile | (4)<br>textual<br>Item 1+7   | (5)<br>$\beta^{UK}$<br>tercile | (6)<br>textual<br>Item 1+7  | (7)<br>$\beta^{UK}$<br>tercile | (8)<br>textual<br>Item 1+7 | (9)<br>$\beta^{UK}$<br>tercile | (10)<br>textual<br>Item 1+7 | (11)<br>$\beta^{UK}$<br>tercile | (12)<br>textual<br>Item 1+7 | (13)<br>col. 1               | (14)<br>col. 2               |
| POST_x.HIGH                                  | 0.0179<br>(0.0381)             | <b>0.0756**</b><br>(0.0328)   | <b>0.0621*</b><br>(0.0398)     | 0.0317<br>(0.0403)           | 0.0245<br>(0.0272)             | -0.0247<br>(0.0459)         | 0.0018<br>(0.0690)             | -0.0256<br>(0.0593)        | 0.0127<br>(0.0448)             | -0.1128<br>(0.0960)         | 0.0270<br>(0.0991)              | -0.1316<br>(0.1116)         | <b>0.2310***</b><br>(0.0470) | <b>0.3570***</b><br>(0.0620) |
| brexit_stock_return                          | <b>0.0447**</b><br>(0.0227)    | 0.0314<br>(0.0468)            | -0.0215<br>(0.0552)            | -0.0042<br>(0.0401)          | 0.0334<br>(0.0320)             | 0.0199<br>(0.0231)          | -0.0016<br>(0.0542)            | -0.0553<br>(0.0463)        | 0.0238<br>(0.0537)             | -0.0341<br>(0.0440)         | -0.0404<br>(0.0757)             | -0.0669<br>(0.0992)         | n.r.                         | n.r.                         |
| brexit_tobins_q                              | <b>0.0673***</b><br>(0.0207)   | <b>0.0590*</b><br>(0.0328)    | <b>0.1356**</b><br>(0.0546)    | <b>0.0554**</b><br>(0.0272)  | 0.0094<br>(0.0085)             | 0.0067<br>(0.0083)          | 0.0163<br>(0.0104)             | 0.0153<br>(0.0140)         | 0.0124<br>(0.0165)             | 0.0137<br>(0.0165)          | 0.0240<br>(0.0237)              | 0.0359<br>(0.0257)          | n.r.                         | n.r.                         |
| brexit_cash_flow                             | 0.3047<br>(0.4697)             | <b>-1.3628**</b><br>(0.5311)  | 0.5083<br>(1.1460)             | -0.2889<br>(0.3260)          | 0.3294<br>(0.3531)             | 0.4344<br>(0.4163)          | 0.0573<br>(0.4489)             | 0.1215<br>(0.4785)         | 0.3798<br>(0.3736)             | 0.4430<br>(0.6837)          | 0.0640<br>(0.4544)              | -0.3386<br>(0.9891)         | n.r.                         | n.r.                         |
| brexit_sales_growth                          | -0.0235<br>(0.0207)            | <b>-0.0530*</b><br>(0.0273)   | -0.0176<br>(nan)               | <b>-0.0461**</b><br>(0.0202) | -0.0129<br>(0.0238)            | -0.0119<br>(0.0151)         | 0.0043<br>(0.0393)             | -0.0086<br>(0.0258)        | -0.0504<br>(0.0309)            | <b>-0.0379*</b><br>(0.0219) | -0.0447<br>(0.0485)             | -0.0465<br>(0.0582)         | n.r.                         | n.r.                         |
| log_assets                                   | -0.0489<br>(0.0452)            | <b>-0.1627***</b><br>(0.0531) | 0.0868<br>(0.1180)             | <b>-0.1008**</b><br>(0.0456) | -0.0230<br>(0.0265)            | <b>-0.0448*</b><br>(0.0246) | -0.0597<br>(0.0420)            | -0.0408<br>(0.0302)        | -0.0337<br>(0.0477)            | <b>-0.0795*</b><br>(0.0427) | -0.1036<br>(0.0760)             | -0.0698<br>(0.0622)         | n.r.                         | n.r.                         |
| cons_fwd                                     | -0.0125<br>(0.0246)            | 0.0239<br>(0.0246)            | -0.0902<br>(0.0841)            | 0.0038<br>(0.0160)           | -0.0025<br>(0.0260)            | -0.0148<br>(0.0189)         | <b>0.0622**</b><br>(0.0295)    | 0.0331<br>(0.0314)         | 0.0163<br>(0.0400)             | -0.0117<br>(0.0309)         | 0.0998<br>(0.0678)              | 0.0309<br>(0.0604)          | n.r.                         | n.r.                         |
| Firm FE                                      | Yes                            | Yes                           | Yes                            | Yes                          | Yes                            | Yes                         | Yes                            | Yes                        | Yes                            | Yes                         | Yes                             | Yes                         | Yes                          | Yes                          |
| Ind.(FIC100)×qtr FE                          | Yes                            | Yes                           | Yes                            | Yes                          | Yes                            | Yes                         | Yes                            | Yes                        | Yes                            | Yes                         | Yes                             | Yes                         | Yes                          | Yes                          |
| PSM (3-NN, w/ repl.)                         | No                             | No                            | Yes                            | Yes                          | No                             | No                          | Yes                            | Yes                        | No                             | No                          | Yes                             | Yes                         | No                           | No                           |
| Binary DV <b>1</b> [UncRes <sub>≥med</sub> ] | No                             | No                            | No                             | No                           | No                             | No                          | No                             | No                         | Yes                            | Yes                         | Yes                             | Yes                         | No                           | No                           |
| N                                            | 17,089                         | 21,354                        | 14,633                         | 21,292                       | 6,658                          | 9,415                       | 5,024                          | 9,407                      | 6,658                          | 9,415                       | 5,024                           | 9,407                       | 17,170                       | 24,195                       |
| Firms                                        | 819                            | 979                           | 716                            | 966                          | 371                            | 526                         | 292                            | 520                        | 371                            | 526                         | 292                             | 520                         | n.r.                         | n.r.                         |
| R <sup>2</sup>                               | 0.0253 <sup>‡</sup>            | 0.0387 <sup>‡</sup>           | 0.0577 <sup>‡</sup>            | 0.0415 <sup>‡</sup>          | 0.0006 <sup>‡</sup>            | -0.0010 <sup>‡</sup>        | -0.0019 <sup>‡</sup>           | 0.0002 <sup>‡</sup>        | 0.0006 <sup>‡</sup>            | -0.0058 <sup>‡</sup>        | -0.0007 <sup>‡</sup>            | -0.0013 <sup>‡</sup>        | 0.21 <sup>†</sup>            | 0.24 <sup>†</sup>            |

Notes: \* $p < .10$ , \*\* $p < .05$ , \*\*\* $p < .01$ ; CASH columns (1)–(4) one-tailed, UncResCEO columns (5)–(12) two-tailed; significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (parentheses) double-clustered firm  $\times$  calendar-quarter. **UncRes** = UncResCEO (DWZ Eq.4 CEO Q&A residual, firm-quarter mean); **UncRes<sub>≥m</sub>** = **1**[UncResCEO  $\geq$  pooled per-arm median] (LPM). **(PSM)** columns re-estimate eq-(14) weighted on the 3-NN-with-replacement propensity-matched sub-panel (our extension; Campello match investment/R&D/divestitures, not cash or uncertainty). <sup>‡</sup>within- $R^2$ ; <sup>†</sup>Campello reported  $R^2$ .

Table 12: Campello Replication: Summary Statistics

| Variable                                                                                     | Rebuild |        |        |        |        | Campello (2022) Table 1 Panel A |        |        |        |        |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|--------|--------|--------|--------|---------------------------------|--------|--------|--------|--------|
|                                                                                              | mean    | SD     | med    | IQR    | N      | mean                            | SD     | med    | IQR    | N      |
| CASH_T1                                                                                      | +0.237  | +0.299 | +0.127 | +0.279 | 75,934 | +0.220                          | +0.250 | +0.120 | +0.270 | 78,044 |
| SIZE                                                                                         | +6.235  | +2.038 | +6.197 | +3.015 | 78,430 | +6.190                          | +2.080 | +6.150 | +3.080 | 78,062 |
| STOCK_RETURNS                                                                                | +0.029  | +0.232 | +0.020 | +0.250 | 64,423 | +0.030                          | +0.240 | +0.020 | +0.250 | 67,226 |
| TOBIN_Q                                                                                      | +2.179  | +1.677 | +1.608 | +1.284 | 72,602 | +2.110                          | +1.590 | +1.570 | +1.260 | 73,353 |
| CASH_FLOW                                                                                    | +0.010  | +0.072 | +0.026 | +0.039 | 75,592 | +0.010                          | +0.060 | +0.030 | +0.040 | 75,287 |
| SALES_GROWTH                                                                                 | +0.179  | +0.685 | +0.064 | +0.243 | 74,607 | +0.160                          | +0.620 | +0.060 | +0.230 | 71,637 |
| CONSENSUS_EPS                                                                                | -0.048  | +1.080 | +0.045 | +0.431 | 47,626 | +0.070                          | +3.510 | +0.090 | +2.050 | 42,031 |
| Firms — market ( $\beta^{UK}$ -tercile, treated)                                             | —       | —      | —      | —      | 478    | —                               | —      | —      | —      | 449    |
| Firms — market ( $\beta^{UK}$ -tercile, control)                                             | —       | —      | —      | —      | 478    | —                               | —      | —      | —      | 360    |
| Firms — textual (§ 1+7, >5 entries, treated)                                                 | —       | —      | —      | —      | 1,458  | —                               | —      | —      | —      | 807    |
| Firms — textual (§ 1+7, zero entries, control)                                               | —       | —      | —      | —      | 465    | —                               | —      | —      | —      | 433    |
| <i>PSM matched sample — CASH (<math>cheq_t/atq_{t-1}</math>, T1) mean and firm count (N)</i> |         |        |        |        |        |                                 |        |        |        |        |
| market PSM matched (treated)                                                                 | +0.215  | —      | —      | —      | 380    | +0.175                          | —      | —      | —      | n.r.   |
| market PSM matched (control)                                                                 | +0.231  | —      | —      | —      | 338    | +0.164                          | —      | —      | —      | n.r.   |
| textual PSM matched (treated)                                                                | +0.228  | —      | —      | —      | 793    | +0.232                          | —      | —      | —      | n.r.   |
| textual PSM matched (control)                                                                | +0.164  | —      | —      | —      | 176    | +0.194                          | —      | —      | —      | n.r.   |

Table 13: Boasiako-Keefe Disclosure-Law Replication

|                         | Boasiako-Keefe (2020)<br>Table 2 Col (1)<br>(1) | This paper (F1D rebuild)<br>CASH      UncResCEO<br>(2)      (3) |                             |
|-------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| Disclosure_Law          | <b>0.0076**</b><br>(0.0031)                     | <b>0.0159**</b><br>(0.0084)                                     | 0.0082<br>(0.0104)          |
| firm_size               | <b>-0.0110***</b><br>(0.0022)                   | <b>-0.0130***</b><br>(0.0023)                                   | -0.0015<br>(0.0010)         |
| firm_age                | <b>-0.0213***</b><br>(0.0044)                   | <b>-0.0652***</b><br>(0.0093)                                   | <b>0.0081*</b><br>(0.0049)  |
| book_leverage           | <b>-0.1400***</b><br>(0.0206)                   | <b>-0.2033***</b><br>(0.0116)                                   | <b>-0.0135*</b><br>(0.0070) |
| market_to_book          | <b>0.0080***</b><br>(0.0015)                    | <b>0.0158***</b><br>(0.0013)                                    | 0.0010<br>(0.0011)          |
| cash_flow               | <b>-0.0049***</b><br>(0.0018)                   | <b>0.1473***</b><br>(0.0203)                                    | 0.0130<br>(0.0188)          |
| capital_expenditure     | <b>-0.0709**</b><br>(0.0280)                    | <b>0.6336***</b><br>(0.1030)                                    | -0.0003<br>(0.0254)         |
| acquisition_expenditure | -0.0052<br>(0.0048)                             | -0.0507<br>(0.0344)                                             | -0.0168<br>(0.0142)         |
| rd_expenditure          | <b>0.1909***</b><br>(0.0281)                    | <b>1.1121***</b><br>(0.0437)                                    | -0.0382<br>(0.0314)         |
| nwc                     | -0.0001<br>(0.0004)                             | <b>-0.0390***</b><br>(0.0110)                                   | -0.0018<br>(0.0029)         |
| dividend_paying         | <b>-0.0072**</b><br>(0.0028)                    | -0.0087<br>(0.0064)                                             | -0.0044<br>(0.0035)         |
| industry_cf_vol         | <b>0.0273***</b><br>(0.0068)                    | <b>0.2635***</b><br>(0.0765)                                    | -0.0006<br>(0.0005)         |
| Industry FE             | Yes                                             | Yes                                                             | Yes                         |
| State FE                | Yes                                             | Yes                                                             | Yes                         |
| Year FE                 | Yes                                             | Yes                                                             | Yes                         |
| N                       | 56,646                                          | 48,336                                                          | 9,709                       |
| R <sup>2</sup>          | 0.494                                           | 0.294                                                           | 0.003                       |

Notes: \* $p < 0.10$ , \*\* $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\* $p < 0.01$  (headline one-tailed  $\beta > 0$ ; controls two-tailed). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at the state level.

Table 14: Disclosure-Law Sample: Summary Statistics

|                           | Boasiako-Keefe (2020) |        |         |        |         | This paper |        |         |        |        |
|---------------------------|-----------------------|--------|---------|--------|---------|------------|--------|---------|--------|--------|
|                           | Mean                  | SD     | p25     | p50    | p75     | Mean       | SD     | p25     | p50    | p75    |
| cash_w                    | 0.2008                | 0.2231 | 0.0285  | 0.1044 | 0.2913  | 0.3195     | 0.5091 | 0.0460  | 0.1507 | 0.3841 |
| firm_size_w               | 5.6136                | 2.0593 | 4.0819  | 5.5717 | 7.0455  | 5.4308     | 2.4517 | 3.7921  | 5.5495 | 7.1420 |
| firm_age_w                | 7.3003                | 0.8889 | 2.0179  | 5.0435 | 11.0918 | 2.3542     | 1.1065 | 1.7918  | 2.5649 | 3.1355 |
| book_leverage_w           | 0.2362                | 0.3177 | 0.0229  | 0.1863 | 0.3528  | 0.2728     | 0.4780 | 0.0033  | 0.1577 | 0.3447 |
| market_to_book_w          | 2.1592                | 2.9919 | 1.1104  | 1.5113 | 2.3119  | 2.9332     | 4.7384 | 1.2013  | 1.6676 | 2.6915 |
| cash_flow_w               | -0.3758               | 4.8386 | -0.0150 | 0.0684 | 0.1210  | -0.1502    | 0.7634 | -0.0616 | 0.0544 | 0.1012 |
| capital_expenditure_w     | 0.0657                | 0.1248 | 0.0174  | 0.0364 | 0.0729  | 0.0565     | 0.0857 | 0.0126  | 0.0289 | 0.0616 |
| acquisition_expenditure_w | 0.0451                | 0.1672 | 0.0000  | 0.0000 | 0.0144  | 0.0318     | 0.0979 | 0.0000  | 0.0000 | 0.0077 |
| rd_expenditure_w          | 0.0709                | 0.1895 | 0.0000  | 0.0021 | 0.0738  | 0.0927     | 0.2082 | 0.0000  | 0.0042 | 0.0913 |
| nwc_w                     | -0.0584               | 1.0372 | -0.0589 | 0.0636 | 0.2157  | -0.1188    | 0.9902 | -0.0794 | 0.0182 | 0.1417 |
| dividend_paying_w         | 0.2767                | —      | 0.0000  | 0.0000 | 1.0000  | 0.2697     | —      | 0.0000  | 0.0000 | 1.0000 |
| industry_cf_vol_w         | 0.3440                | 0.5270 | 0.0825  | 0.1403 | 0.2499  | 0.0737     | 0.0576 | 0.0383  | 0.0577 | 0.0936 |
| Observations              | 56,646                |        |         |        |         | 48,336     |        |         |        |        |

## Empire-Building Run-Up Test — Regression Specification

All four regressions share one estimating equation; they differ only in the outcome  $Y$  and in which firms are eligible to be treated. Estimator: two-way fixed-effects OLS (PanelOLS), firm-clustered standard errors.

$$Y_{i,t} = \beta \text{PreAnnounceQtr}_{i,t} + \gamma' \mathbf{X}_{i,t} + \alpha_i + \tau_t + \varepsilon_{i,t}$$

where  $i$  indexes the firm (its earnings call) and  $t$  the calendar year-quarter.  $\beta$  is the coefficient of interest: one-tailed test ( $H_1 : \beta > 0$ ) for PreAnnounceQtr, two-tailed for the controls.

| Reg. | Outcome $Y$ | Treated set (firms eligible for PreAnnounceQtr = 1) |
|------|-------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| (1)  | CashRatio   | Cash acquirers ( $\geq 50\%$ cash)                  |
| (2)  | UncResCEO   | Cash acquirers ( $\geq 50\%$ cash)                  |
| (3)  | CashRatio   | Stock acquirers ( $\geq 50\%$ stock) — placebo      |
| (4)  | UncResCEO   | Stock acquirers ( $\geq 50\%$ stock) — placebo      |

| Symbol                                                                                        | Definition                                                                                                                                                                       | Role                                                             |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <i>Outcomes</i>                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                  |
| CashRatio                                                                                     | cheq/atq (Compustat)                                                                                                                                                             | cash-holdings level (first stage)                                |
| UncResCEO                                                                                     | residual $\widehat{\varepsilon}_{ic}$ from $\text{UncAnsCEO}_{ic} = \alpha + \text{CEO-FE}_i + \mathbf{X}_{ic}\gamma + \varepsilon_{ic}$ (DWZ Eqn. 4)                            | call-level CEO Q&A uncertainty, net of the CEO's permanent style |
| <i>Treatment</i>                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                  |
| PreAnnounceQtr <sub><math>i,t</math></sub>                                                    | = 1 in the single quarter immediately before firm $i$ 's first qualifying deal ( $e = -1$ ); post-announcement quarters ( $e \geq 0$ ) are dropped; never-acquirers are always 0 | pre-event (anticipation) indicator                               |
| <i>Controls <math>\mathbf{X}</math> (H1 cash set, lagged DV removed; Compustat quarterly)</i> |                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                  |
| Leverage                                                                                      | (dlcq + dlttq)/atq                                                                                                                                                               | interest-bearing debt / assets                                   |
| lnAssets                                                                                      | ln(atq)                                                                                                                                                                          | firm size                                                        |
| TobinsQ                                                                                       | (atq + cshoq · prccq – ceqq)/atq                                                                                                                                                 | market-to-book / growth opportunities                            |
| ROA                                                                                           | iby/assets                                                                                                                                                                       | profitability                                                    |
| Capex                                                                                         | capxy/atq                                                                                                                                                                        | investment intensity                                             |
| DivDummy                                                                                      | ≠[dvy > 0]                                                                                                                                                                       | dividend payer                                                   |
| sCFO                                                                                          | 5-yr rolling SD of oancfy/atq <sub><math>t-1</math></sub>                                                                                                                        | cash-flow volatility                                             |
| <i>Fixed effects / errors</i>                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                  |
| $\alpha_i$                                                                                    | firm fixed effect (EntityEffects)                                                                                                                                                | removes each firm's permanent level (within-firm identification) |
| $\tau_t$                                                                                      | calendar year-quarter fixed effect (TimeEffects)                                                                                                                                 | removes economy-wide shocks each quarter                         |
| $\varepsilon_{i,t}$                                                                           | idiosyncratic error, clustered by firm                                                                                                                                           |                                                                  |

*Reading the columns.* (1)–(2) are the cash-acquirer arm: does cash, and then CEO uncertainty, rise in the quarter before a cash-financed deal? (3)–(4) are the stock-acquirer placebo: stock buyers face the same pending-deal disclosure gag but hold no cash war-chest, so (4) flat while (2) positive  $\Rightarrow$  the uncertainty rise is cash-specific, not mere deal secrecy.

Table 15: Empire-Building Run-Up Test

|                      | Cash acquirers                |                              |                               |                               | Stock acquirers (placebo)     |                             |                               |                               |
|----------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-----------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                      | (1)<br>CashRatio              | (2)<br>UncResCEO             | (3)<br>CashScrutiny           | (4)<br>HighCashScrutiny       | (5)<br>CashRatio              | (6)<br>UncResCEO            | (7)<br>CashScrutiny           | (8)<br>HighCashScrutiny       |
| PreAnnounceQtr       | <b>0.0071***</b><br>(0.0030)  | <b>0.0461***</b><br>(0.0172) | 0.0854<br>(0.0749)            | <b>0.0408**</b><br>(0.0194)   | -0.0015<br>(0.0062)           | -0.0429<br>(0.0307)         | -0.3222<br>(0.2024)           | -0.0303<br>(0.0313)           |
| Leverage             | <b>-0.0515***</b><br>(0.0161) | -0.0338<br>(0.0217)          | -0.1521<br>(0.1470)           | -0.0179<br>(0.0308)           | <b>-0.0743***</b><br>(0.0144) | -0.0292<br>(0.0196)         | -0.1056<br>(0.1358)           | -0.0428<br>(0.0262)           |
| LnAssets             | <b>-0.0339***</b><br>(0.0049) | -0.0037<br>(0.0082)          | -0.0391<br>(0.0482)           | <b>0.0190**</b><br>(0.0096)   | <b>-0.0311***</b><br>(0.0037) | -0.0043<br>(0.0063)         | <b>-0.0733**</b><br>(0.0369)  | 0.0077<br>(0.0078)            |
| TobinsQ              | <b>0.0099***</b><br>(0.0024)  | -0.0031<br>(0.0030)          | -0.0208<br>(0.0144)           | 0.0006<br>(0.0027)            | <b>0.0102***</b><br>(0.0016)  | -0.0017<br>(0.0025)         | -0.0113<br>(0.0123)           | 0.0030<br>(0.0024)            |
| ROA                  | 0.0217<br>(0.0142)            | 0.0499<br>(0.0321)           | <b>-0.5659**</b><br>(0.2254)  | <b>-0.1006**</b><br>(0.0405)  | <b>0.0245*</b><br>(0.0138)    | <b>0.0530*</b><br>(0.0296)  | <b>-0.5350***</b><br>(0.1982) | <b>-0.0869**</b><br>(0.0366)  |
| Capex                | <b>-0.1571***</b><br>(0.0416) | 0.0842<br>(0.0986)           | <b>-1.2215***</b><br>(0.3534) | <b>-0.3646***</b><br>(0.0880) | <b>-0.1764***</b><br>(0.0393) | 0.1256<br>(0.1006)          | <b>-1.4479***</b><br>(0.3000) | <b>-0.4470***</b><br>(0.0793) |
| DivDummy             | 0.0002<br>(0.0038)            | -0.0030<br>(0.0106)          | -0.0561<br>(0.0537)           | -0.0111<br>(0.0107)           | -0.0022<br>(0.0035)           | <b>-0.0137*</b><br>(0.0080) | -0.0564<br>(0.0384)           | <b>-0.0146*</b><br>(0.0087)   |
| sCFO                 | <b>0.0034**</b><br>(0.0017)   | 0.0052<br>(0.0085)           | <b>0.1180***</b><br>(0.0140)  | <b>0.0235***</b><br>(0.0028)  | 0.0035<br>(0.0021)            | -0.0009<br>(0.0110)         | <b>0.0906***</b><br>(0.0337)  | <b>0.0169***</b><br>(0.0057)  |
| Firm FE              | Yes                           | Yes                          | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                         | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| Cal. Year-Quarter FE | Yes                           | Yes                          | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                           | Yes                         | Yes                           | Yes                           |
| Firms                | 2,245                         | 1,248                        | 1,237                         | 1,237                         | 2,290                         | 1,338                       | 1,325                         | 1,325                         |
| N (firm-quarters)    | 73,642                        | 27,622                       | 26,216                        | 26,216                        | 92,116                        | 39,377                      | 37,065                        | 37,065                        |
| R <sup>2</sup>       | 0.054                         | 0.001                        | 0.002                         | 0.002                         | 0.058                         | 0.001                       | 0.002                         | 0.002                         |

Notes: \* $p < 0.10$ , \*\* $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\* $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for the treatment coefficient,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. CashScrutiny (cols 3, 7) and HighCashScrutiny (cols 4, 8) are estimated on the UncResCEO call universe. HighCashScrutiny is an LPM on  $\mathbf{1}[\text{CashScrutiny} > \text{median}]$ ; the median is 0 (89% of calls raise no cash turns), so it flags any cash scrutiny ( $\approx 11\%$  of calls).



Table 16: Analyst Cash-Scrutiny Validity (Link 1)

|                      | DV: CashScrutiny (% of analyst Q&A turns on cash/liquidity) |                                |                               |                                |
|----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|-------------------------------|--------------------------------|
|                      | (1)                                                         | (2)                            | (3)                           | (4)                            |
| CashRatio            | <b>0.7530</b> ***<br>(0.0949)                               | <b>0.8519</b> ***<br>(0.0967)  |                               |                                |
| HighCash             |                                                             |                                | <b>0.1754</b> ***<br>(0.0237) | <b>0.1921</b> ***<br>(0.0236)  |
| Leverage             | —                                                           | <b>0.2180</b> **<br>(0.0978)   | —                             | <b>0.2030</b> **<br>(0.0987)   |
| lnAssets             | —                                                           | <b>-0.0562</b> ***<br>(0.0213) | —                             | <b>-0.0744</b> ***<br>(0.0212) |
| TobinsQ              | —                                                           | <b>-0.0272</b> ***<br>(0.0089) | —                             | <b>-0.0218</b> **<br>(0.0085)  |
| ROA                  | —                                                           | <b>-0.5012</b> ***<br>(0.1339) | —                             | <b>-0.5002</b> ***<br>(0.1335) |
| Capex                | —                                                           | <b>-1.2348</b> ***<br>(0.2890) | —                             | <b>-1.3259</b> ***<br>(0.2900) |
| DivDummy             | —                                                           | <b>-0.0674</b> **<br>(0.0331)  | —                             | <b>-0.0678</b> **<br>(0.0331)  |
| sCFO                 | —                                                           | 0.0244<br>(0.0274)             | —                             | 0.0291<br>(0.0277)             |
| Firm FE              | Yes                                                         | Yes                            | Yes                           | Yes                            |
| Cal. Year-Quarter FE | Yes                                                         | Yes                            | Yes                           | Yes                            |
| Controls             | No                                                          | Yes                            | No                            | Yes                            |
| Firms                | 1,868                                                       | 1,853                          | 1,868                         | 1,853                          |
| N (calls)            | 75,087                                                      | 72,670                         | 75,087                        | 72,670                         |
| R <sup>2</sup>       | 0.002                                                       | 0.005                          | 0.001                         | 0.004                          |

Notes: \* $p < 0.10$ , \*\* $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\* $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed for the cash coefficient,  $\beta > 0$ ; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level.

## Cash-Scrutiny Measure: Variable Construction (Link 1)

### Variable definitions.

- **CashScrutiny<sub>*i,t*</sub>** — share (%) of call *i*'s analyst Q&A turns whose text contains at least one *cash level* or *liquidity* term (listed below); a turn-level binary averaged over the call's analyst Q&A turns.
- **CashRatio<sub>*i,t*</sub>** = cheq/atq (cash & equivalents ÷ total assets).
- **High Cash<sub>*i,t*</sub>** = 1[CashRatio<sub>*i,t*</sub> ≥ top tercile].
- **Controls *X<sub>i,t</sub>***: Leverage, ln(Assets), Tobin's Q, ROA, Capex, Dividend Payer, Cash Flow (sCFO).

**Specification.** Two-way fixed-effects OLS estimated at the call level:

$$\text{CashScrutiny}_{i,t} = \beta \text{Cash}_{i,t} + \gamma' X_{i,t} + \alpha_i + \delta_{q(t)} + \varepsilon_{i,t},$$

where Cash<sub>*i,t*</sub> = CashRatio (cols 1–2) or High Cash (cols 3–4);  $\alpha_i$  = firm fixed effects,  $\delta_{q(t)}$  = calendar year-quarter fixed effects; standard errors clustered by firm. The cash coefficient  $\beta$  is the external-validity test. **Search terms.** An analyst Q&A turn is flagged if, after the *excluded* phrases are blanked out, its lower-cased text contains any phrase below, matched on a word boundary (case-insensitive). Every literal spelling actually searched is listed: where a phrase has a singular/plural or hyphenated/closed variant (e.g. 'noncash' and 'non-cash'), both forms appear. Disposition/payout terms (dividends, buybacks) are deliberately *not* used here: they load on firm size and maturity and would correlate with CashRatio spuriously rather than through cash attention.

- **Cash level** (22 forms) — *why*: they name the firm's cash stockpile or balance itself, the direct object of attention to how much cash the firm holds.  
'cash holding', 'cash holdings', 'cash balance', 'cash balances', 'cash position', 'cash on hand', 'cash on the balance sheet', 'cash reserve', 'cash reserves', 'cash and cash equivalents', 'cash and equivalents', 'cash and shortterm investments', 'cash and short-term investments', 'net cash', 'cash pile', 'cash hoard', 'cash stockpile', 'war chest', 'dry powder', 'excess cash', 'idle cash', 'surplus cash'
- **Liquidity** (5 forms) — *why*: standard analyst synonyms for the same liquid-asset buffer.  
'liquidity', 'liquid assets', 'shortterm investments', 'short-term investments', 'marketable securities'
- **Excluded** (17 forms) — *why*: they contain “cash” but denote cash *flow*, earnings, an accounting basis, or an idiom rather than the cash holdings, so they are blanked out before matching to prevent false positives.  
'free cash flow', 'operating cash flow', 'cash flow statement', 'cash flow', 'cash flows', 'cash conversion cycle', 'cash conversion', 'cash basis', 'cash cow', 'cash compensation', 'noncash', 'non-cash', 'cash register', 'cash crop', 'cash taxes', 'cash earnings', 'cash in on'

Table 17: Analyst Cash-Scrutiny Channel (Link 2)

|                                                                                         | UncResCEO<br>(DWZ residual) | UncAnsCEO<br>(raw Q&A) |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|------------------------|
| <i>Panel A. OLS — DV in continuous level</i>                                            |                             |                        |
| CashScrutiny                                                                            | -0.0000<br>(0.0013)         | 0.0001<br>(0.0013)     |
| <i>N</i> (calls)                                                                        | 41,512                      | 41,512                 |
| Within $R^2$                                                                            | 0.000                       | 0.000                  |
| <i>Panel B. Logit — DV = <math>\mathbf{1}[\text{measure} \geq \text{median}]</math></i> |                             |                        |
| CashScrutiny (log-odds)                                                                 | -0.0003<br>(0.0074)         | 0.0080<br>(0.0085)     |
| <i>N</i> (calls)                                                                        | 41,512                      | 41,512                 |
| Pseudo $R^2$                                                                            | 0.002                       | 0.019                  |
| Firm FE (A) / Industry FE (B)                                                           | Yes                         | Yes                    |
| Cal. Year-Quarter FE                                                                    | Yes                         | Yes                    |

*Notes:* DV is CEO Q&A uncertainty as the DWZ residual (UncResCEO, firm/linguistic component removed) or the raw measure (UncAnsCEO, pooled-1% winsorized). CashScrutiny = the share (%) of a call's Q&A turns devoted to cash topics (validated in the Link 1 table). Panel A is OLS on the continuous DV; Panel B is a logit on  $\mathbf{1}[\text{DV} \geq \text{sample median}]$ . \*  $p < 0.10$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$  (two-tailed); significant coefficients in **bold**; SE (parentheses) clustered at firm level. Coarser scrutiny measures (any-turn, raw count, log count) give the same null.

Table 18: Cash-Scrutiny Reason-Gating Test

|                                      | UncResCEO                     |                              |
|--------------------------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------|
|                                      | (1)                           | (2)                          |
| CashScrutiny                         | 0.0000<br>(0.0018)            | 0.0001<br>(0.0018)           |
| PreAnnounceQtr                       | <b>0.0413</b> ***<br>(0.0177) | <b>0.0439</b> **<br>(0.0189) |
| CashScrutiny $\times$ PreAnnounceQtr |                               | -0.0056<br>(0.0111)          |
| Controls                             | Yes                           | Yes                          |
| Firm FE                              | Yes                           | Yes                          |
| Cal. Year-Quarter FE                 | Yes                           | Yes                          |
| N (firm-quarters)                    | 26,216                        | 26,216                       |
| Firms                                | 1,237                         | 1,237                        |
| $R^2$                                | 0.001                         | 0.001                        |

Notes: \* $p < 0.10$ , \*\* $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\* $p < 0.01$  (one-tailed,  $\beta > 0$ , for the directional terms); significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Estimated on cash-acquirer firms ( $\geq 50\%$ -cash acquisitions; SDC, US public, 2002–2018) over their pre-announcement and earlier quarters (post-announcement quarters dropped); PreAnnounceQtr = 1[the single quarter before announcement]. Sample restricted to calls with both CashScrutiny and UncResCEO (the matched universe). CashScrutiny = % of a call's analyst Q&A turns on cash/liquidity. The reason (PreAnnounceQtr) raises CEO residual uncertainty; analyst cash-scrutiny does not, and the interaction is insignificant.